

will be used for wireless sync. Each time your phone has been connected to wall power for at least 10 minutes and detects the configured Wi-Fi network, it will search out the syncing PC and begin syncing content in both directions automatically.

Once the settings have been verified, the wizard will inform you that wireless sync has been configured and you're good to go. Chances are you won't have nearly as much use for the data cable in the future: Simply charging your phone in the same room or often just in the same house as the PC is all you'll need to do.

Wipe your phone clean

Every once in a while you may find yourself in a situation where you simply want to start over again with a clean phone OS devoid of all the media, apps, documents, pictures and other gunk that's been piling up since Day One of using the phone. Windows Phone supports a way of starting over from scratch. Before going down this path, take some steps to ensure that everything on the phone is backed up somewhere. The simplest thing you can do is connect the phone physically to your syncing PC via a USB cable and let the Zune PC software copy everything from the device to the PC. Here are some common data types to think about:

- ▶ **Email, contacts and calendars:** Since your Windows Phone email, contacts and calendar accounts all live up in the cloud, there's not too much you need to do there, aside from ensuring that you know all the login information (usernames and passwords) and, for more complex account types, the required server settings.
- ▶ **Messages:** Your text messages and any pictures received via messages will be deleted when you wipe out the phone. There's no way to save messages, but you can, of course, save any pictures to the phone and then sync them to the PC.
- ▶ **Games and applications:** Any games and applications you've downloaded to the phone – paid, free or trial – can't be backed up, but then they don't need to be. You can simply download them at any time from the Windows Phone Marketplace, and you won't have to repay for any apps you've already purchased. If you have many such apps, you may want to just save their names.